

Assessment Criterion	Level 4 (Excellent)	Level 3 (Good)	Level 2 (Satisfactory)	Level 1 (Needs Improvement)
Problem Understanding & Objectives (IA) 3%	Clearly explains the problem, motivation, objectives, scope, assumptions, and constraints with strong understanding.	Explains the problem and objectives with minor omissions.	Basic understanding; lacks clarity in objectives or justification.	Unable to explain the problem or objectives satisfactorily.
Literature Review (Minimum 3 Papers per Student) (IA) 5%	Reviews 3 or more assigned research papers critically, compares approaches, identifies research gaps, and explains relevance to the project.	Reviews assigned papers with adequate comparison and identifies basic research gaps.	Reviews papers descriptively with limited comparison or weak research gap analysis.	Incomplete review or unable to explain assigned papers.
Dataset & Data Preparation (IA) 4%	Clearly explains dataset selection, characteristics, preprocessing decisions, and justifies the chosen techniques.	Good explanation with minor omissions in justification or preprocessing.	Basic explanation with limited understanding of preprocessing decisions.	Unable to justify dataset selection or preprocessing techniques.
Technical Understanding & Communication (IA) 3%	Demonstrates excellent understanding of the proposed NLP pipeline and communicates ideas confidently during viva.	Good understanding with minor gaps in explanation.	Partial understanding; requires significant prompting.	Unable to explain technical concepts or contribution.

Dataset Collection & Documentation (GA) 2%	Dataset is appropriate, well documented, justified, and includes source, characteristics, licensing, and annotation details (if applicable).	Dataset is suitable with minor omissions.	Dataset documentation is incomplete or weakly justified.	Dataset selection/documentation is inadequate.
Data Preparation & EDA (GA) 2%	Appropriate preprocessing workflow and EDA are well designed, justified, and documented.	Most preprocessing steps are appropriate with adequate documentation.	Basic preprocessing and limited EDA.	Preprocessing workflow is incomplete or incorrect.
NLP Pipeline Design (GA) 4%	Comprehensive architecture, workflow, feature representation, model selection, and proposed evaluation strategy are well justified.	Pipeline is complete with minor gaps in justification.	Basic pipeline with limited justification.	Pipeline is incomplete or missing major components.
Report Quality & Team Coordination (GA) 2%	Report is well organized, technically sound, professionally formatted, and demonstrates effective collaboration.	Report is complete with minor formatting or coordination issues.	Report is adequate but lacks consistency or organization.	Poorly organized report with significant omissions.